01-Exercise-Checklist

Purple Team Exercise Checklist

Pre-Exercise (Planning Phase)

Sponsors & Coordination

- ❑ Sponsor approval obtained
- ❑ Budget approved
- ❑ Exercise Coordinator assigned
- ❑ Goals and objectives defined
- ❑ Attendees selected from each team

Cyber Threat Intelligence

- ❑ Target organization understood
- ❑ Adversary identified for emulation
- ❑ CTI gathered and analyzed
- ❑ TTPs extracted at procedure level
- ❑ Adversary emulation plan created
- ❑ Table-top TTP review completed

Technical Preparation

- ❑ Target systems provisioned
- ❑ Security tools verified on targets
- ❑ Target accounts created
- ❑ Attack infrastructure ready
- ❑ External/internal infra configured
- ❑ Payloads tested on non-exercise systems
- ❑ Allowlists verified with Blue Team
- ❑ Cloud accounts/subscriptions scoped and authorized
- ❑ Identity provider access confirmed in scope
- ❑ Cloud security tools verified and reporting

Logistics

- ❑ Location secured (physical or virtual)
- ❑ Video conferencing tested
- ❑ Agenda distributed to all attendees
- ❑ Metrics defined and agreed upon
- ❑ Exercise case created in DFIR system

Exercise Day

Kick-Off

- ❑ Sponsor delivers opening remarks
- ❑ Introductions completed
- ❑ Exercise flow presented
- ❑ Communication channels confirmed

For Each TTP

- ❑ CTI presents adversary context
- ❑ Table-top: Expected controls discussed
- ❑ Red Team executes TTP (screen shared)
- ❑ Red Team provides: IP, target, exact time, IOCs
- ❑ Blue Team investigates and responds
- ❑ Metrics captured (TTD, TTI, TTR)
- ❑ Detection gaps identified
- ❑ Action items documented

Coordination

- ❑ Exercise Coordinator taking notes
- ❑ Action items being tracked
- ❑ Breaks provided as scheduled
- ❑ Daily summary emails sent (multi-day)

Post-Exercise (Lessons Learned)

Immediate (Same Day)

- ❑ Feedback forms distributed

- ❑ Initial findings discussed
- ❑ Quick wins identified

Within 2 Weeks

- ❑ Lessons learned document compiled
- ❑ Report delivered to sponsors
- ❑ Action items assigned to owners
- ❑ Remediation timelines established

Follow-Up

- ❑ Detection engineering completed (see Detection Lifecycle Checklist)
- ❑ TTPs retested after fixes (see Hunt-to-Detection Pipeline)
- ❑ Results added to tracking system
- ❑ Maturity model updated (see PTMM Poster)
- ❑ Next exercise planned

Purple Team Exercise Framework v4 — github.com/scythe-io/purple-team-exercise-framework